BARCAMP PHILLY · 2026

LARPing as an Extrovert

A practical guide to networking, small talk, and other social side quests

Meg Gutshall · @meg-gutshall · in/meghan-gutshall

WHO IS THIS SESSION FOR?

A session for people who (at times) struggle with... *peopling*.

WHAT WILL I GET OUT OF THIS SESSION?

How to get comfortable with being uncomfortable

01 **Where to start**

Nervous about networking? There are plenty of opportunities! Let's find a fit that's right for you.

02 **What to say**

You've made it to a conference or event full of people. Now, what the heck do you talk about?

03 **When to retreat**

Conserve your social battery and still have a wildly successful experience. Is it possible? Can it be?

SOCIAL GATHERINGS SURROUND YOU

Networking opportunities may be hiding in plain sight

PREPARE AHEAD OF TIME

Lessen your emotional burden on the day of the event



Find a buddy

See if you know anyone who is planning to attend the same event, or invite someone along.



Enlist social media

Post on social media about the upcoming event using their hastags!



Nail down logistics

Figure out your mode of travel ahead of time.



Sharing is preparing

Volunteer your expertise, time, connections, or belongings.

TALK ABOUT ANYTHING AT ALL

Just be yourself

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Social skills are *SKILLS!*

CONVERSATION STRATEGIES

Some tips and tricks to hit it off with anyone

Remembering a name

- Look at the color of their eyes
- Find an alliterative trait to remember
- If you forget, fess up

Including others

- Approach people who are alone
- Interrupt interrupters
- Use the Pac-Man strategy

Making the connection

- Don't hover
- It's okay to circle back
- Ask to connect on LinkedIn

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TIME TO RELAX

Make room to recharge

IT'S OKAY TO NOPE OUT WHEN YOU HAVE TO

Figure out what works best for you and stick with it

You may want to...

- Arrive early to get a lay of the facilities
- Block out some time in the schedule to go to your car or hotel room and close your eyes
- Call someone for support
- Stay an extra night on your own dime for a work trip so you don't have to fly home directly from the training

All of these strategies are acceptable and understandable –
especially to other introvert-leaning people!

Now go out there and slay those social scaries!

Thank you

MEG GUTSHALL · @MEG-GUTSHALL · IN/MEGHAN-GUTSHALL